
Variable Roles in Code Models: Surface Transfer Tracks Language Lineage, Probe Transfer Does Not

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Abstract

1 If language is a design axis rather than a passive carrier, then changing the language
2 should change what a model can do. We test this in code, where one problem
3 can be written in several languages whose relatedness is fixed independently of
4 our results. Using XLCoST solutions aligned problem by problem across Python,
5 JavaScript and PHP, we fit a variable-role classifier on one language and evaluate
6 on another over all six ordered pairs. A model-free character n -gram baseline with
7 the variable’s own name masked is strongly constrained by language relatedness:
8 macro-F1 0.952 between JavaScript and PHP, falling to 0.785 whenever Python is
9 involved. A linear probe on a code model’s residual stream moves 0.006 across
10 the same boundary. The probe is not reading the input: an untrained network of
11 identical architecture reaches 0.575 and both trained models clear it in all 18 cells.
12 The base model the code model is continued from is almost as invariant (-0.011),
13 so code-*specialised* pretraining is not the cause. The surface fails not because its
14 discriminative n -grams are missing (70% of weighted mass survives, $r = +0.09$
15 with transfer) but because they point the other way: the share whose sign flips
16 predicts transfer at $r = -0.98$. The medium governs surface generalisation
17 and leaves the learned role representation largely untouched, a dissociation a
18 behavioural evaluation would report as one degraded number.

1 Introduction

20 Treating language as a design axis presumes the medium is not neutral: rephrasing a problem changes
21 what a model does with it. Programming languages make that testable in a way natural languages
22 rarely do. Code models demonstrably encode a great deal about programs [Karmakar and Robbes,
23 2021, Troshin and Chirkova, 2022], but what survives a change of language is a separate question,
24 and the same algorithm can be written in Python, JavaScript and PHP with the semantics fixed, the
25 surface varying along the C-family/off-side-rule split, and the corpora aligned problem by problem.
26 If the medium constrains what a model represents, code is where that can be measured instead of
27 argued.

28 In natural language, transfer tracks relatedness closely enough that typological distance is used to
29 choose source languages [Lin et al., 2019, Littell et al., 2017], and word-order divergence alone
30 degrades it [Ahmad et al., 2019]. Whether the same holds for programming languages is untested,
31 and a single cross-lingual accuracy conflates the two things that would answer it: how far a surface
32 regularity carries, and how far a learned representation does. Variable roles make the separation
33 tractable. A *role* [Sajaniemi, 2002], such as accumulator, loop iterator or index key, is a property of
34 what a variable does, not of its name or its language, so the medium ought in principle to be irrelevant
35 to it. Whether it is irrelevant *to a model* then has a measurable answer.

We contribute a controlled measurement of that separation and a mechanism for the part that fails. Over all six ordered pairs of Python, JavaScript, and PHP, a model-free surface baseline tracks language relatedness closely while a linear probe on the residual stream does not. An untrained network of identical architecture separates the trained network’s contribution from our inputs’, and the base model the code model is continued from shows the effect does not require code specialisation. The surface fails for a reason that is not the obvious one: its features are present in the target and carry the opposite sign.

2 Setup

Corpus and alignment. XLCOST [Zhu et al., 2022] provides parallel solutions to competitive-programming problems in several languages, keyed by a problem identifier that is stable across languages. Every comparison below is *matched*: a classifier trained on A and evaluated on B sees only problems appearing in both, so a drop in transfer cannot be a change of subject matter. Matching is also what restricts the study to three languages. We computed the full pairwise overlap (Appendix A): Python/JavaScript/PHP share 2,953, 1,529, and 1,145 problems, and *no* other pair in XLCOST reaches 500, including same-family pairs such as C# and Java, which share 175. The three-language limit is a property of the benchmark, not a choice.

Roles and occurrences. We extract per-occurrence labels for accumulator, iterator, and index_key from language-specific parsers, cap each role at 3,000 occurrences sampled as whole problems, and use a frozen hash-based split that assigns a problem to the same fold in every language. Test folds hold 1,377–3,341 occurrences with smallest-class counts of 138–1,645, so one occurrence of the smallest class changing its prediction moves the surface baseline’s macro-F1 by $\rho \in [0.0003, 0.0020]$ and the probe’s by $[0.0016, 0.0132]$. Every transfer figure in Table 1 clears its own ρ by more than an order of magnitude. The per-class ablations of Section 5 do not, and we read them only as an upper bound.

What is compared. The *surface baseline* is a character n -gram classifier over the context around an occurrence, with every instance of the variable’s own name replaced by a placeholder, fitted on the source language and applied to the target. It involves no model. Its score is the strongest of three masked-context variants per cell, and fixing any single variant in advance gives a *larger* boundary drop (-0.173 to -0.276 against the -0.166 we report), so the reported figure is the conservative choice. The *probe* is a logistic regression on residual-stream activations pooled over the occurrence, with the layer chosen on source-language validation data.

The two are not given the same input. The probe pools over the identifier’s own tokens and therefore reads the name. The baseline is forbidden from reading it. We report the identifier alone as a third model-free row of Table 1, so the asymmetry is on the page.

We compare three models: Qwen2.5-Coder-1.5B [Hui et al., 2024]; Qwen2.5-1.5B [Qwen et al., 2024], the general-purpose base model it is continued from, sharing its architecture, scale, and tokenizer but not its code-specialisation stage; and an untrained network with that architecture and randomly initialised weights.

XLCOST distributes Python through a formatted mirror and the other two through a detokenized one, so the lineage boundary is also a formatting boundary. The character analyser discards whitespace before extracting n -grams, and equalising it moves transfer by 0.0000 (Appendix C).

3 The medium is encoded, and organised by lineage

First, does the model represent the medium at all? Applying PCA to last-token residual activations over seven XLCOST languages, language identity is linearly recoverable from the embedding layer onward: PC1 correlates with a static/dynamic typing label at $r = +0.883$ at layer 0, peaks at $|r| = 0.941$ at layer 4 carrying 37% of the variance, and decays to 0.576 by layer 28 (Appendix D).

The typing axis is not privileged. A control rules out reading that as internalised type discipline. Relabelling the same activations under every alternative 4-versus-3 partition of the seven languages

Table 1: Cross-lingual role transfer, macro-F1 averaged over three roles and the ordered pairs in each group. The two model-free rows differ in what they may read: the first masks the variable’s name, the second uses nothing else. The probe pools over the identifier’s tokens and so reads the name, which is why the identifier-alone row is reported beside it. The model-free rows track the lineage boundary. The trained probes do not, and the untrained network is flat only in the sense of being uniformly poor.

	JavaScript↔PHP	pairs involving Python	change
Surface n -gram, name masked (no model)	0.952	0.785	−0.166
Identifier alone (no model)	0.867	0.810	−0.056
Probe, Qwen2.5-Coder-1.5B	0.893	0.887	−0.006
Probe, Qwen2.5-1.5B (base)	0.899	0.888	−0.011
Probe, untrained (same arch.)	0.590	0.568	−0.021

84 $\binom{7}{4} = 35$ groupings minus the real one, so 34 controls), the true static/dynamic split reaches best-
85 layer F1 1.000 and the arbitrary partitions average 0.996, with 5 of 34 matching or exceeding it. Any
86 grouping is near-perfectly decodable because what the model encodes is language *identity*, and a
87 partition is recoverable as a union of identities whether or not it means anything.

88 What survives is the arrangement: the two pairs sitting closest are the two that are historically closest,
89 C beside C++ and Java beside C#. The medium is represented sharply and, at least locally, by descent.

90 4 Role transfer across the lineage boundary

91 Table 1 splits the six ordered pairs by whether Python, the one language in the matched triangle
92 outside the C family, is involved.

93 **The surface is constrained by the medium.** Between JavaScript and PHP the n -gram baseline
94 reaches 0.952 with no model and without seeing the variable’s name. Across the Python boundary
95 it loses 0.166. The extreme cell is iterator from PHP to Python, falling to 0.576 against 0.965 from
96 PHP to JavaScript: same source language, same feature family, refit on each pair’s own matched
97 set (208 problems against 248). The probe on those cells barely moves (0.865 and 0.851), so the
98 collapse is not an artefact of the smaller set.

99 **The representation is not.** The same split costs the code model’s probe 0.006. Across all 18 cells
100 the probe’s scores are far less dispersed than the masked baseline’s (SD 0.028 against 0.100). The
101 probe does not uniformly beat the baseline. It loses all six cells of the closely related pair, where
102 n -grams have already saturated: the model contributes nothing where surface similarity is high and a
103 great deal where it is low.

104 **Two controls decide what this means.** A flat curve is worthless if the probe reads the input rather
105 than the model, and worthless again if it is flat only because it is uniformly poor. An untrained
106 network of the same architecture bounds both [Hewitt and Liang, 2019, Belinkov, 2022]. The
107 untrained network settles both. It reaches 0.575 overall against 0.889 and 0.892 for the trained
108 models, gaps of 0.314 and 0.316 on average, positive in *all eighteen* cells for both, with a minimum
109 per-cell lift of 0.126. the probes are reading something the networks learned. It is also flat in group
110 mean, dropping 0.021, though its per-cell scores range from 0.417 to 0.780, so what is flat is the
111 average and not the network. That is exactly why flatness alone proves nothing: a network that
112 separates the roles poorly everywhere is close to indifferent to where it fails. The trained models also
113 give up far less against their own in-domain ceilings (0.045 and 0.035) than the untrained one does
114 (0.199). What distinguishes the trained models is being flat *and* high. The untrained network is not
115 at chance either. It clears its own shuffled-label control by 0.111, as random projections of token
116 identity should, so 0.575 rather than 0.5 is the floor a representational claim must clear.

117 **Code specialisation is not the cause.** The base model of identical architecture, scale, and tokenizer
118 is nearly as invariant: it moves −0.011 against the code model’s −0.006, both an order of magnitude
119 below the surface baseline’s −0.166. Whatever makes the role representation insensitive to the

medium is not the code-specialisation corpus. No genuinely code-free model exists in this family, so the contrast isolates that stage, not code exposure.

5 Why the surface fails: form–meaning realignment, not missing forms

Calling the drop typological names it without explaining it. Because the baseline fits its vectoriser on the source and only transforms the target, an n -gram the target never produces contributes exactly zero, which makes the mechanism measurable.

The obvious explanation is wrong. Weighting each feature by $|\beta_j|$ times its mean tf-idf, roughly 70% of the source classifier’s discriminative mass is realised in *every* target, including the worst (0.697 against 0.735). Surviving mass shows no detectable relationship with transfer ($r = +0.09$, 95% CI $[-0.78, +0.84]$): it stays inside a 0.70–0.86 band while F1 spans 0.58–0.97. The cues are present.

What predicts transfer is whether they mean the same thing. The failure has the shape of a false-friends effect in the classifier’s feature space: the discriminative forms survive into the target, but their mapping to roles reverses, and it is the reversed share rather than the missing share that predicts transfer. Fitting a second classifier on the target labels in the same feature space, the share of target-realised mass whose sign flips between the two tracks transfer strongly ($r = -0.98$, CI $[-1.00, -0.79]$; -0.91 under a source-weighted variant): 5–7% between JavaScript and PHP against 18–37% across the Python boundary, with no overlap between the groups.

The realignment is distributed rather than localised, which is not consistent with the reading “typological” invites. For the iterator role and the two PHP-source pairs that bracket the entire 18-cell spread, masking an orthographic character class on both sides (terminators, braces, brackets, parentheses, or operators) moves transfer by at most 0.021 against a 0.39 gap (Table 6). none of these deltas is large relative to its own resolution, which is the point. Indentation and keywords are not ablated, so this bounds punctuation, not syntax in general. We report the aggregate only: single coefficients of a regularised model over correlated character n -grams are not interpretable one at a time.

Related work. Probing shows code models encode identifier, type and structural information recoverable by linear classifiers [Karmakar and Robbes, 2021, Troshin and Chirkova, 2022]. We ask what survives a change of language, pairing every probe with a model-free baseline on the same occurrences. Multilingual encoders carry a separable language-identity component and a structured geometry [Libovický et al., 2020, Chang et al., 2022, Pires et al., 2019], and multilingual training transfers across programming languages [Ahmed and Devanbu, 2022]. We find that geometry in a code model and show role transfer is largely insensitive to it. Methodologically we follow the argument that a probe score needs a bound on what architecture and labels alone supply [Hewitt and Liang, 2019, Zhang and Bowman, 2018, Voita and Titov, 2020, Belinkov, 2022].

6 Discussion

Read against the design-axis premise, our results split it in two. The medium constrains surface generalisation, and the model encodes it sharply enough to place historically adjacent languages together (Section 3). Yet it leaves the learned role representation nearly untouched, in a network without code-specialised pretraining. A behavioural evaluation reporting one cross-lingual accuracy would average these into a single degraded number and attribute it to the language, when the language is doing all of its work at the surface.

Limitations. The matched triangle instantiates “closely related” by one pair and the boundary by one language. The axis has two points on it and no gradient, and Appendix A shows XLCoST admits no wider version. Both trained models are 1.5B parameters from one family, so nothing here speaks to scale, and that family has no code-free member.

Role labels come from an AST for Python and regular expressions for the other two, and the paths do not carve *iterator* identically, so those cells mix the representational effect with an extractor-definition difference (Appendix F). Accumulator and index_key, whose extractors agree far better, show the same direction. Section 5 runs on iterator alone, its ablation on two of six pairs, its correlations on six points. The probe is correlational, and Appendix E’s interventions cover a different role.

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241 A Pairwise problem overlap in XLCOST

Table 2: Shared problem identifiers between every pair of XLCOST languages, train split. Matched cross-lingual transfer needs a pair to share enough problems to hold out a test fold; only the three bold cells clear 500. No pair outside Python/JavaScript/PHP does, including same-family pairs.

	C++	C#	Java	JavaScript	PHP	Python
C++	—	115	122	75	17	74
C#	115	—	175	75	14	62
Java	122	175	—	85	11	66
JavaScript	75	75	85	—	1,529	2,953
PHP	17	14	11	1,529	—	1,145
Python	74	62	66	2,953	1,145	—

242 B Full transfer table

243 C Transfer mechanism

244 D Language geometry

245 **The typing axis is not privileged.** Probing the same activations under every alternative 4-versus-3
 246 partition of the seven languages ($\binom{7}{4} = 35$ groupings minus the real one, so 34 controls) gives
 247 best-layer macro-F1 0.9959 on average (min 0.9918, max 1.0000), against 1.0000 for the true
 248 static/dynamic split; 5 of the 34 controls match or exceed it. Any grouping of these languages is
 249 near-perfectly decodable, so the decodability of the typing split is evidence that language identity is
 250 encoded, not that type discipline is. At layer 4, where $|r|$ peaks at 0.941, the remaining components
 251 carry almost none of the label: PC2 $r = -0.014$, PC3 $r = +0.026$, PC4 $r = +0.171$.

Table 3: All eighteen transfer cells for Qwen2.5-Coder-1.5B. *Surface* is the strongest masked-context n -gram feature; *name* uses the variable’s name alone; *probe* is the residual-stream probe. Majority and shuffled-label controls sit near chance throughout, and ρ is the macro-F1 movement from one test occurrence changing its prediction.

role	pair	n	surface	name	probe	major.	shuf.	ρ
accumulator	JavaScript→PHP	1,976	0.951	0.897	0.904	0.361	0.470	0.0005
accumulator	JavaScript→Python	3,341	0.813	0.873	0.875	0.415	0.473	0.0004
accumulator	PHP→JavaScript	1,903	0.954	0.897	0.918	0.372	0.490	0.0005
accumulator	PHP→Python	1,377	0.782	0.824	0.833	0.276	0.439	0.0008
accumulator	Python→JavaScript	3,294	0.785	0.874	0.918	0.370	0.504	0.0003
accumulator	Python→PHP	1,478	0.736	0.845	0.874	0.271	0.466	0.0007
index_key	JavaScript→PHP	1,976	0.940	0.834	0.897	0.384	0.478	0.0005
index_key	JavaScript→Python	3,341	0.859	0.787	0.883	0.330	0.497	0.0003
index_key	PHP→JavaScript	1,903	0.964	0.838	0.880	0.376	0.516	0.0005
index_key	PHP→Python	1,377	0.839	0.782	0.854	0.387	0.515	0.0008
index_key	Python→JavaScript	3,294	0.871	0.822	0.915	0.314	0.470	0.0003
index_key	Python→PHP	1,478	0.858	0.838	0.874	0.419	0.459	0.0008
iterator	JavaScript→PHP	1,976	0.937	0.862	0.906	0.448	0.488	0.0008
iterator	JavaScript→Python	3,341	0.774	0.733	0.939	0.444	0.472	0.0005
iterator	PHP→JavaScript	1,903	0.965	0.873	0.851	0.446	0.478	0.0008
iterator	PHP→Python	1,377	0.576	0.788	0.865	0.428	0.462	0.0010
iterator	Python→JavaScript	3,294	0.790	0.769	0.918	0.466	0.484	0.0007
iterator	Python→PHP	1,478	0.741	0.788	0.902	0.475	0.438	0.0020

Table 4: Probe transfer per model, averaged within each group. The untrained network shares Qwen2.5-1.5B’s architecture and tokenizer with randomly initialised weights; it is the floor a representational claim must clear, and it is itself flat.

model	close pair	Python pairs	all	vs. untrained
Qwen2.5-1.5B	0.899	0.888	0.892	+0.316
Qwen2.5-Coder-1.5B	0.893	0.887	0.889	+0.314
Qwen2.5-1.5B (untrained)	0.590	0.568	0.575	—

E Causal interventions

Scope. Causal interventions were run for the *boolean* role over 5 languages (C++, Java, JavaScript, PHP, Python), 3 models, and 3 intervention modes (ablate, patch, steer), giving 375 layer-wise measurements. They are reported here rather than in the main text because they were run *within* languages and on a role outside the three this paper transfers, so they cannot support its central claim. Specificity is $|\text{clean} - \text{intervened}|$ divided by the same quantity for a random-position control: how much of the effect is specific to the variable’s own token positions rather than to editing anything at all. Two columns are given because the layer with the largest effect is generally not the layer with the best specificity, and quoting either alone misleads.

F Role-label extraction

Role labels come from an AST walk for Python and from regular expressions for JavaScript and PHP, and the two paths do not carve *iterator* identically. A C-style counter that also accumulates is dropped as multi-role in JavaScript and PHP but retained as an iterator in Python, so the iterator cells mix the representational effect with a difference in what the extractors call an iterator. The other two roles are less affected and carry the same direction: accumulator transfers at 0.782 php→python against 0.954 php→javascript, and index_key at 0.839 against 0.964. The paper’s claim therefore does not rest on the role whose labels agree least across the boundary.

Table 5: Transfer mechanism for the iterator role. *Surviving* is the share of the source classifier’s discriminative mass realised in the target; *flip* is the share of that mass whose sign reverses. Surviving mass is uncorrelated with transfer; flipped mass predicts it almost exactly. Source-weighted variants are given for robustness.

pair	F1	surviving	flip	agree	flip (src-wt.)
PHP→JavaScript	0.965	0.735	0.072	+0.895	0.072
JavaScript→PHP	0.937	0.698	0.052	+0.945	0.068
Python→JavaScript	0.790	0.862	0.178	+0.695	0.211
JavaScript→Python	0.774	0.757	0.232	+0.811	0.241
Python→PHP	0.741	0.696	0.280	+0.528	0.367
PHP→Python	0.576	0.697	0.366	+0.476	0.346

Table 6: Masking an entire syntactic character class on both sides of the transfer. No class accounts for more than 0.021 of the 0.39 gap, so the realignment is distributed rather than carried by block delimiters or statement terminators.

pair	masked class	macro-F1	Δ
PHP→JavaScript	terminator	0.9496	-0.0159
PHP→JavaScript	brace	0.9645	-0.0010
PHP→JavaScript	bracket	0.9711	+0.0057
PHP→JavaScript	paren	0.9609	-0.0045
PHP→JavaScript	operator	0.9441	-0.0213
PHP→Python	terminator	0.5786	+0.0030
PHP→Python	brace	0.5750	-0.0006
PHP→Python	bracket	0.5733	-0.0023
PHP→Python	paren	0.5947	+0.0191
PHP→Python	operator	0.5801	+0.0045

269 G Reproducibility

270 Every figure in the main text is regenerated from committed result files by the released pipeline, and
271 a regression test recomputes each of them, including the three correlations of Section 5, from those
272 files rather than quoting them. The appendix tables are emitted by `make_appendix.py` from the
273 same CSVs and are not written by hand.

274 **Models.** Qwen/Qwen2.5-Coder-1.5B and Qwen/Qwen2.5-1.5B, loaded in `float16`. The un-
275 trained control instantiates the second model’s configuration with randomly initialised weights
276 under a fixed seed, and records its identity as `Qwen/Qwen2.5-1.5B#random-init-s0` so that no
277 downstream artefact can be mistaken for the trained run.

278 **Classifiers.** The surface baseline is a `char_wb` tf-idf vectoriser with $n \in [2, 4]$, `min_df` = 2 and at
279 most 60,000 features, fitted on the source language only, followed by logistic regression with $C = 4$,
280 balanced class weights, and at most 2,000 iterations. The probe is logistic regression with $C = 1$
281 on residual activations mean-pooled over the occurrence’s token span, with the layer chosen on a
282 source-language validation fold and results averaged over five seeds.

283 **Compute.** Activation extraction is the only step needing an accelerator: one forward pass per
284 program, roughly 8,700 programs per model across the three languages, about an hour on a single
285 mid-range GPU, producing stores of roughly 1.6 GB in `float16` at this scale. Everything else,
286 including all surface baselines, the mechanism analyses, and the ablations, is CPU-only and runs in
287 minutes.

288 **Data.** Section 3 draws on a separate activation-extraction pipeline. Its layer ta-
289 ble, principal-component correlations, and bucket-control figures are committed under
290 `results/lp4fm/language_geometry/`, and the values quoted are read from those files. No
291 claim in Sections 4–5 depends on it.

Table 7: Point-biserial correlation between PC1 of last-token residual activations and a static/dynamic typing label, by layer, with PC1’s explained-variance ratio. The sign of r is arbitrary (PCA fixes the axis only up to reflection, and each layer is refit independently); magnitude is what carries meaning.

layer	$ r $	EVR	layer	$ r $	EVR
0	0.883	0.481	15	0.894	0.309
1	0.898	0.447	16	0.882	0.303
2	0.914	0.391	17	0.874	0.296
3	0.939	0.373	18	0.873	0.289
4	0.941	0.370	19	0.873	0.299
5	0.862	0.369	20	0.903	0.291
6	0.828	0.361	21	0.886	0.276
7	0.844	0.342	22	0.859	0.265
8	0.896	0.339	23	0.842	0.252
9	0.919	0.333	24	0.812	0.242
10	0.880	0.327	25	0.774	0.253
11	0.893	0.302	26	0.694	0.255
12	0.917	0.292	27	0.732	0.237
13	0.904	0.314	28	0.576	0.242
14	0.898	0.309			

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1. Claims

Table 8: Causal interventions on boolean-flag occurrences. *Peak-effect spec.* is specificity at the largest-effect layer; *best spec.* is the maximum over layers, with that layer named.

language	mode	model	peak-effect spec.	best spec. (layer)
C++	ablate	qwen2515b	4.5×	31.9× (L4)
C++	ablate	qwen25coder15b	4.4×	76.2× (L20)
C++	ablate	starcoder27b	4.3×	36.5× (L4)
C++	patch	qwen2515b	3.6×	7.9× (L20)
C++	patch	qwen25coder15b	3.6×	6.9× (L8)
C++	patch	starcoder27b	8.1×	10.4× (L16)
C++	steer	qwen2515b	45.0×	169.8× (L4)
C++	steer	qwen25coder15b	598.5×	598.5× (L24)
C++	steer	starcoder27b	6.9×	341.1× (L4)
Java	ablate	qwen2515b	28.5×	86.0× (L12)
Java	ablate	qwen25coder15b	12.3×	62.4× (L12)
Java	ablate	starcoder27b	27.0×	27.0× (L4)
Java	patch	qwen2515b	6.1×	7.7× (L12)
Java	patch	qwen25coder15b	5.9×	7.7× (L12)
Java	patch	starcoder27b	7.5×	8.6× (L12)
Java	steer	qwen2515b	72.1×	849.0× (L8)
Java	steer	qwen25coder15b	71.9×	186.6× (L0)
Java	steer	starcoder27b	252.0×	252.0× (L24)
JavaScript	ablate	qwen2515b	26.7×	26.7× (L16)
JavaScript	ablate	qwen25coder15b	28.1×	116.3× (L24)
JavaScript	ablate	starcoder27b	27.3×	27.3× (L4)
JavaScript	patch	qwen2515b	6.9×	6.9× (L8)
JavaScript	patch	qwen25coder15b	6.6×	7.4× (L12)
JavaScript	patch	starcoder27b	8.1×	8.2× (L16)
JavaScript	steer	qwen2515b	24.5×	76.4× (L8)
JavaScript	steer	qwen25coder15b	65.2×	149.5× (L4)
JavaScript	steer	starcoder27b	11.2×	60.8× (L28)
PHP	ablate	qwen2515b	15.0×	102.4× (L20)
PHP	ablate	qwen25coder15b	26.5×	79.2× (L20)
PHP	ablate	starcoder27b	19.4×	19.7× (L8)
PHP	patch	qwen2515b	7.2×	7.2× (L4)
PHP	patch	qwen25coder15b	4.7×	7.4× (L0)
PHP	patch	starcoder27b	6.3×	9.3× (L16)
PHP	steer	qwen2515b	190.3×	190.3× (L24)
PHP	steer	qwen25coder15b	11.5×	134.0× (L8)
PHP	steer	starcoder27b	8.7×	100.1× (L4)
Python	ablate	qwen2515b	5.8×	36.7× (L24)
Python	ablate	qwen25coder15b	6.8×	33.1× (L16)
Python	ablate	starcoder27b	26.5×	26.5× (L4)
Python	patch	qwen2515b	6.0×	7.2× (L16)
Python	patch	qwen25coder15b	6.7×	7.8× (L16)
Python	patch	starcoder27b	7.9×	9.7× (L12)
Python	steer	qwen2515b	209.1×	827.9× (L16)
Python	steer	qwen25coder15b	1025.8×	1025.8× (L24)
Python	steer	starcoder27b	8.6×	55.5× (L4)

322 Question: Do the main claims made in the abstract and introduction accurately reflect the
323 paper’s contributions and scope?

324 Answer: [Yes]

325 Justification: The abstract and Section 1 state the transfer figures, the untrained floor, and the
326 mechanism result, and each is the number reported in Sections 4 and 5. Claims are scoped
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